

KATIA & MAURICE KRAFFT

French volcanologists
1942–1991 & 1946–1991

Explosive eruptions of hot gas, ash, and lava make volcanoes some of the most dangerous places on the planet. However, for both Katia and Maurice Krafft, it was love at first sight! As a child, Katia was captivated by films about the fiery forces that shape the Earth. For Maurice, one glimpse of a real-life volcano made him determined to study geology (the science of the Earth itself).

 Stromboli,
Italy

Katia and Maurice's careers began with a trip to Stromboli, an active island volcano in Italy.

 Eldfell, Iceland

Katia and Maurice became famous for the daring risks they took to capture eruptions on camera, including Eldfell in 1973.

Katia and Maurice met in college and soon arranged to visit an active volcano together—Stromboli, in Italy. Every few minutes, Stromboli belched out ash, bits of glowing lava, and lumps of stone. The couple returned from the trip with amazing photographs. They realized they could sell photographs and films to fund a life of visiting volcanoes!

Volcano gear

Safety gear, such as silver, protective suits that reflect the intense heat from volcanoes, can only protect volcanologists from some of the dangers. They need to be careful and prepared for anything when working.